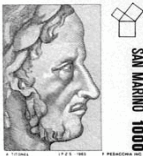
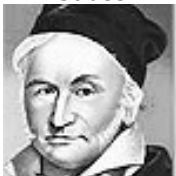


Famous Mathematicians

Mathematician	Period	Contribution
Thales 	Greek c. 600 B.C.	The first Greek known to have used proof and strict logical reasoning to solve mathematical questions
Pythagoras 	Greek c. 500 B.C.	Influential Greek philosopher and religious leader. He taught that numbers and ratios of numbers were the foundation of reality. He discovered many number patterns and the proof that the square root of two is not rational.
Euclid 	Greek c. 300 B.C.	Organized Greek geometry into a mathematical system based on fundamental definitions, a few postulates and theorems that are logically deduced. This work, known as the <u>Elements</u>, had a profound influence on mathematics for thousands of years.
Archimedes 	Greek c. 250 B.C.	Discovered many fundamental properties of physics, such as the law of the lever; discovered a way to approximate pi as accurately as desired
Apollonius 	Greek c. 250 B.C.	Discovered the family of curves known as the conic sections. He analyzed their properties using Greek geometry (not, however, with modern algebra equations or graphing techniques).
Ptolemy 	Greek c. 130 A.D.	Invented a planetary system that was adopted as truth by the Christian church in Medieval Europe. In this system the Earth does not move and the planets, moon, stars and the Sun revolve around the Earth in circular paths with constant motion. This was described in his book the <u>Almagest</u>.
Al-Khwarizmi 	Hindu-Arabic c. 800 A.D.	Wrote influential Arabic books on solving algebra problems and the Hindu-Arabic numeration system.
Viete 	Early Modern 1540 - 1603	Introduced symbols into algebra.

Descartes 	Early Modern 1596 - 1650	Developed analytic geometry. He used a sophisticated symbolic algebra to show how algebra can be used to solve geometry problems and how algebra problems can be solved with geometry.
Fermat 	Early Modern 1601 - 1665	Developed analytic geometry. He showed how a geometric curve, such as a conic section, could be drawn on a coordinate grid from an algebra equation. He also made important contributions to number theory, including the famous "Fermat's Last Theorem"
Kepler 	Early Modern 1571 - 1630	Used real astronomical data to show that the planets orbit the sun in elliptical paths at varying rates of speed.
Newton 	Early Modern 1643 - 1727	Co-inventor of the calculus. He proved Kepler's laws mathematically in the style of Euclid in his book the <u>Principia</u>
Leibniz 	Early Modern 1646 - 1716	Co-inventor of the calculus. His methods and symbolism is used today.
Euler 	Early Modern 1707 - 1783	A founding father to many branches of mathematics. He lived in the generation that followed Newton and Leibniz. Modern calculus textbooks derive from his works on calculus. He is also responsible for many modern symbols, such as $f(x)$, e, i, π
Gauss 	Modern 1777 - 1855	Discovered non-Euclidean geometry. He was a pioneer in many areas of modern mathematics.
Cantor 	Modern 1845 - 1918	Invented the theory of infinite sets. He proved that the counting numbers and the real numbers have a different cardinality.
von Neumann 	Modern 1903 - 1957	Designed the fundamental structure of modern computer design, known as the "von Neumann architecture". He also invented a branch of mathematics known as "game theory".

